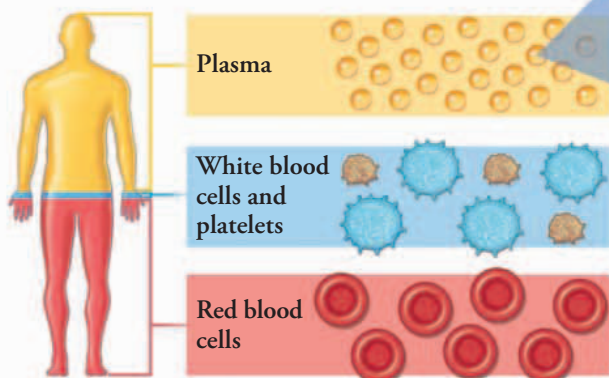


Liquid life

Your blood is made of trillions of cells floating in a watery liquid called plasma—it is the red cells in your blood that give it its color. Every drop of blood goes on an incredible journey around your body thousands of times a day, carrying out vital tasks to keep your body working properly.

THE INGREDIENTS

Most of your blood is made from plasma—a clear liquid. The rest consists of red blood cells, white blood cells, and tiny cell pieces called platelets. Each ingredient carries out a specific task.



▲ **PLASMA** *This liquid carries the nutrients needed to keep your body cells alive.*

► **BLOOD VESSEL** *This cutaway view of a blood vessel shows the different blood cells carried in plasma.*

SUPER SERVICE

Transported by a network of tubes called blood vessels, blood delivers fuel and oxygen to your cells and takes away waste that would otherwise be harmful. Blood also distributes heat, keeping your body at a constant temperature. Its white blood cells form the first line of defense against germs that get into your body, while an army of platelets spring into action when it's time to heal wounds.

WOW!

A pinhead-sized drop of blood contains about 2.5 million red blood cells, 3,750 white blood cells, and 160,000 platelets.

White blood cells defend your body by destroying germs. They are the largest of the blood cells.

A blood vessel has a smooth lining so that blood flows through it easily.